daily and now, because she was required to devote total concentration to this course, she was unable to do so. This aspect was troubling her a lot. The Guru replied: 'My child. You have been performing your *paath* for years every day. It helps you in concentrating on the right moral code that you should follow. It is like a form of meditation. Without betraying your faith you are learning another form. For this your full attention is required. You cannot digress. After eleven days, start your prayers again. You will be more involved; you will be able to understand what you are doing much better. You will be doubly benefited by your faith, and by your conduct.'

A British girl, who was doing time under the NDPS Act, and who had been in Tihar for more than four years, had a more physical problem to contend with. She was uncertain whether she could continue with this course as she became nauseous at times and felt she could not cope with this physical discomfort.

The Guru responded: 'But why are you afraid? What is happening to you is an operation. If a doctor severs a boil on your body, will not the pus flow out? You are undergoing a surgery of the mind. What is wrong within you is flowing out. It was like pus in you. Let it flow out. Be happy that it is flowing out.' The girl returned to her place of *sadhana* with tears besmearing her face. And yet her expression revealed a glimpse of salvation.

Tarseem Kumar, superintendent of Jail 2, conducted a survey on *Vipassana* in his jail three weeks after the launch of the course. Two sets of interviews were arranged. One was with those prisoners who had undergone the course and the other was with their cellmates in order to verify the authenticity of the former's claims. The results spoke volumes about the beneficial effect the course had had on the participants:

1. Ninety-six per cent had control over their anger. Four per cent had not achieved total control, but the frequency had come down considerably.
2. Ninety per cent felt less stressful and had achieved a marked degree of peace of mind.
3. Ninety-six per cent could concentrate on subjects of their choice.
4. All of them exhibited a sense of benevolence and compassion towards fellow inmates and staff.
5. Ninety-eight per cent were in a better physical condition. They no longer suffered from repeated bouts of stomachache, headache and other such minor ailments.
6. All of them had become more truthful.
7. Sixty-six per cent had stopped thinking about the past and were focusing on the present.
8. Eighty-six per cent had become more tolerant of others and so less selfish.
9. All of them had found an improvement in self-discipline.
10. Eight per cent meditated twice a day; 6 per cent once a day; and 6 per cent irregularly.

Amongst members of the staff, the survey revealed the following factors:

1. An increase in their sense of duty and devotion.
2. Positive changes in their behaviour pattern.
3. Improved relationships with the prisoners.

A young white American male undertrial, not wishing to give his name, did not think much about what was happening in Tihar: 'Look, there's nothing great happening here. We have our human rights. They have to be respected. We are not animals, man, so we have to be treated like human beings. As a